11-07 第二篇

Space Exploration: Reaching for the Stars

Humans have always looked up at the night sky with wonder. For thousands of years, we could only imagine what lay beyond Earth. Today, rockets carry astronauts into space, and robots explore Mars, the Moon, and distant planets. Space exploration has taught us about our solar system, led to new technologies, and inspired generations to dream big. [1] Space exploration represents one of humanity's greatest ambitions—to understand the universe and our place within it.

Space programs require enormous effort and cooperation. Engineers design rockets and spacecraft; scientists plan missions and analyze data; astronauts train for years before a single flight. Countries around the world work together on the International Space Station, where astronauts from different nations live and work in orbit. Private companies are now also building rockets and planning trips to the Moon and beyond. [2] Space exploration is a global endeavor that brings together the best minds and resources from around the world, pushing the boundaries of what is possible.

The benefits of space exploration reach far beyond space itself. Satellites in orbit help us predict weather, navigate with GPS, and communicate across the globe. Technologies first developed for space missions—such as water filters, medical devices, and lightweight materials—are now used in everyday life. Studying other planets helps us understand Earth better, including its climate and environment. [3] The discoveries and innovations from space programs have improved life on Earth in countless ways, often in surprising and practical applications.

Space exploration also faces challenges. Missions are expensive and sometimes dangerous. Space junk orbiting Earth creates risks for satellites and spacecraft. Long journeys to Mars or beyond pose physical and psychological challenges for astronauts. Yet the desire to explore continues to drive progress. [4] Despite these obstacles, the promise of new discoveries and the spirit of exploration keep humanity moving forward, aiming for the Moon, Mars, and the stars beyond.

What does the future hold? Plans are underway for permanent bases on the Moon and human missions to Mars. Telescopes and probes will continue to search for signs of life elsewhere in the universe. Young people studying science, technology, engineering, and math today may one day design the next spacecraft or walk on another planet. [5] The next generation of explorers will carry the dream of space travel forward, turning today's science fiction into tomorrow's reality.

选项

A. Space exploration represents one of humanity's greatest ambitions—to understand the universe and our place within it. B. Space exploration is a global endeavor that brings together the best minds and resources from around the world, pushing the boundaries of what is possible. C. The discoveries and innovations from space programs have improved life on Earth in countless ways, often in surprising and practical applications. D. Despite these obstacles, the promise of new discoveries and the spirit of exploration keep humanity moving forward, aiming for the Moon, Mars, and the stars beyond. E. The next generation of explorers will carry the dream of space travel forward, turning today's science fiction into tomorrow's reality. F. For instance, the Perseverance rover on Mars has been collecting rock samples that scientists hope will reveal whether life ever existed on the planet.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍人类对天空的好奇——千百年来只能想象，如今火箭载人、机器人探火星月球和行星，太空探索带来知识、技术与梦想，空后需概括太空探索的人类ambition。A的"one of humanity's greatest ambitions"与前文"always looked up... with wonder"和"inspired generations"呼应，"to understand the universe and our place within it"与前文"taught us about our solar system"对应。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前描述太空计划所需——工程师设计、科学家规划、宇航员多年训练，各国合作建设国际空间站，私人公司参与月球等计划，空后需总结太空探索的全球协作性。B的"global endeavor that brings together the best minds and resources"与前文多国、多角色合作对应，"pushing the boundaries of what is possible"与"robots explore Mars"等呼应。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前列举太空探索对地球的回报——卫星预测天气、GPS、全球通讯，航天技术转化为净水器、医疗设备、轻质材料等民用产品，研究其他行星帮助理解地球气候与环境，空后需总结发现与创新对生活的改善。C的"discoveries and innovations from space programs have improved life on Earth"与前文各例呼应，"surprising and practical applications"与净水器、医疗设备等对应。
- **[4] D**：

- **线索**：空前说太空探索的挑战——成本高、有风险、太空垃圾、火星等长途任务的身心压力，同时强调探索欲仍推动进步，空后需总结尽管有障碍仍继续前行的原因。D的"Despite these obstacles"与前文挑战呼应，"promise of new discoveries and the spirit of exploration"与"desire to explore continues to drive progress"对应，"Moon, Mars, and the stars beyond"与前文目标呼应。

- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：空前展望未来——月球基地、火星任务、望远镜寻找地外生命迹象、今日学STEM 的青年可能设计飞船或登陆他星，空后需总结下一代探索者的使命。E的"The next generation of explorers"与前文"Young people studying... today"呼应，"turning today's science fiction into tomorrow's reality"与"dream big"和"Plans are underway"对应，是合理收尾。

- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For instance, the Perseverance rover on Mars has been collecting rock samples that scientists hope will reveal whether life ever existed on the planet.**：以For instance开头，为毅力号火星车的具体案例。各空均为概括或过渡句；[3]易被误选因涉及太空发现，但该空需总结太空项目对地球生活的多种影响，而非单一火星采样任务。